

MA, Xiao

CONTACT	xma@sjd.law.harvard.edu • Cambridge, MA • +1 (617) 800-7091 https://www.maxiao.law	
EDUCATION	Harvard Law School , Cambridge, MA <i>S.J.D.</i> Dissertation: <i>Political Determinants of Bankruptcies in China</i> Research Fields & Supervisors: Bankruptcy and Corporate Reorganization with Mark Roe (Principal); Comparative Corporate Law and Corporate Theories with Reinier Kraakman; China's Political Economy with Mark Wu Fellowships & Grants: Graduate Program Fellow; Cravath International Summer Travel Grants; Conference Travel Grants; Fairbank Center Graduate Conference Grant; Mercatus Fellowship Research: Research Assistant to Prof. William Alford, Prof. Howell Jackson, Prof. Mark Roe Teaching: Teaching Fellow, Bankruptcy (Spring 2022, Fall 2022); LLM Advisor	May 2027 (expected)
	Harvard Law School , Cambridge, MA <i>LL.M.</i> F.Y. Chang Scholar; Honors Thesis on Intragroup Guarantees and Complications in Bankruptcy	2016
	University of Oxford , St. Hilda's College <i>Magister Juris</i> China Oxford Scholar; Distinction in Public International Law	2012
	Beijing Foreign Studies University <i>LL.B. and B.A. in English</i> Scholarships; Honors Thesis on International Humanitarian Law	2011
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Bankruptcy and Corporate Reorganization; Comparative Corporate Law; Chinese Law and Political Economy; Law and Political Economy; Corporate Finance; Sovereign and Municipal Debt; Empirical Legal Studies	
WORKING PAPERS	<i>State-in-Possession: Big Firm Reorganizations in China</i> (job market paper) Presented: Harvard Graduate Colloquium (2024); Texas A&M Law (2024); Oxford Law (2025); Cambridge Chinese Politics Workshop (2025); American Society of Comparative Law (2025); Duke Law (2025); National Business Law Scholars Conference (2026). Forthcoming: Harvard Asia Law Junior Scholars Conference (2026); Harvard–Wharton–Chicago Insolvency & Restructuring Conference (2026). <i>Allocating Loss: Municipal Bankruptcy and Fiscal Discipline in China</i> Presented: Association for Asian Studies (2026); Law & Society Association Annual Meeting (2026); Sciences Po (2026). <i>Bankruptcy as State Policy</i>	
OTHER WRITING & EDITORIAL	“Crypto-Bankruptcy Series: Concluding Thoughts,” Harvard Law School Bankruptcy Roundtable (Chief Editor for Special Series).	

“China Continues to Issue New Rules in Promotion of Corporate Rescue Culture,”
Harvard Law School Bankruptcy Roundtable.
“Tribune II: Law Firm Perspectives” and “Ultra III: Law Firm Perspectives,” Harvard
Law School Bankruptcy Roundtable.
Harvard International Law Journal, Editor; HLS Bankruptcy Roundtable, Chief Editor;
Kanfa (BFSU Law Review), Chief Editor

EXPERIENCE

Southern Methodist University , Dallas, TX <i>Visiting Scholar, Comparative Political Economy and Society</i>	2025 – 2026
Texas A&M University School of Law , Fort Worth, TX <i>Visiting Scholar, Global Program</i>	2024 – 2025
Harvard Law School , Cambridge, MA <i>Bankruptcy Fellow; Visiting Scholar / East Asian Legal Studies</i>	2019 – 2021
Reorg , Hong Kong SAR (Part-time) <i>China Analyst</i>	2019 – 2020
Kirkland & Ellis , Hong Kong SAR <i>Restructuring / Litigation Associate</i>	2016 – 2019
Fangda Partners , Shanghai <i>Dispute Resolution Associate</i>	2012 – 2015
SJ Berwin LLP (King & Wood Mallesons), London <i>Summer Vacation Scheme</i>	2012
MWE China Law Offices (McDermott Will & Emery), Shanghai <i>Summer Associate</i>	2010

BAR, & MEMBERSHIPS

Bar Admissions: China (qualified 2013, registered 2014); New York (admitted 2017)
Professional Memberships: American Bankruptcy Institute; INSOL International &
INSOL China; Law & Society Association; American Society of Comparative Law;
American Law and Economics Association; Association for Asian Studies; European
Corporate Governance Institute

COMMUNITY & SERVICE

- Association for Asian Studies – Panel Organizer (2026)
- Alumnae-I Network for Harvard Women, Dallas DSG — President (2025, 2026)
- Harvard College Admission Alumni Interviewer (2024, 2025, 2026)
- Faculty Women's Club of the UTSW — Board Member (2024, 2025, 2026)
- Ian Fletcher Cross-Border Insolvency Moot — Coach to Universitas Brawijaya, Indonesia (2025)
- Law & Society Association Annual Meeting — Panel Chair and Discussant (2025)
- Harvard Club of Dallas (2023, 2024, 2025)
- Language Access Program at HLS Clinical Programs (2023, 2024)
- Tsinghua University Law School — Advisor on Student Research Training (2021)
- East China University of Political Science and Law — Guest Lecturer (2021)
- Project Doing Business, World Bank — Contributor, China's bankruptcy law and practice (2015, 2016)
- Willem C. Vis Moot, Shanghai Round — Arbitrator (2015)
- Philip C. Jessup International Law Moot, China Round — Judge (2014)